Dimapuno Ramos Datu

Sultan Atty. Dimapuno Ramos Datu, popularly known by his Maranaw name **Pangnal** (literally, "The Inquirer"), is a Maranaw lawyer, educator, journalist, and elected public official from Raya, Balindong, Lanao del Sur, in the Bangsamoro region of the Philippines.

Born on June 12, 1945, Pangnal is a Sultan of the Royal House of Raya Present and one of the top 50 model Sultans of Iranaon. His career cuts across academia, law, broadcast media, civic leadership, and provincial governance, making him one of the more genuinely multi-dimensional public figures in the history of Muslim Mindanao.

He's best remembered for his years as Vice-Governor of Lanao del Sur, where his advocacy for clean and transparent government earned him national recognition, and for his work in radio journalism, where his no-holds-barred commentaries made him a trusted voice in the Maranaw community.

His life, as those who know him often put it, has been one of continuous involvement and relevance.

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EARLY LIFE AND EDUCATION

Pangnal was born on June 12, 1945, in Raya, Balindong, Lanao del Sur, into a family with ties to the Royal House of Raya.

He showed early on that he was built for excellence: he graduated as Valedictorian in both elementary and high school.

He went to Manila for higher studies, enrolling at the University of the East (UE), where he earned his Bachelor of Arts in Political Science graduating Cum Laude. He was also awarded the Dalupan Law Scholarship, through which he completed his Bachelor of Laws (LLB) at the same institution.

Not stopping there, he went on to take doctoral units in Political Science at the University of the Philippines Diliman in Quezon City, deepening a scholarly foundation that would inform everything he did in public life afterward.

It's the kind of academic record that reflects genuine drive, not just native ability.

ACADEMIC CAREER

Pangnal's most sustained academic role was at Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City, where he served as Dean of the College of Business Administration from 1980 to 1985.

Those five years left a clear mark. Under his leadership, the college produced two CPA board topnotchers and won the University Leadership Award two successive times. The college also bagged the Miss University Contest twice consecutively, a testament to how Pangnal ran his unit: with energy, pride, and an eye for developing the whole student.

He also had oversight of the MSU student publication "PAGSIBOL" (meaning "DAWN"), the university's student organ, reflecting his belief that student voices deserved a platform and a home.

Beyond the deanship, he served as a Professional Lecturer and Professor at MSU's College of Law and College of Business Administration, and as the university's Chief Legal Counsel, a role that put his legal training directly in service of the institution he helped build.

He was also a former President of the Dansalan Junior College Alumni Association in Marawi City. The association's membership of roughly 2,000 professionals spread across the country formed a significant backbone of the regional, provincial, city, and municipal government bureaucracy in Muslim Mindanao and especially in Lanao del Sur.

JOURNALISM AND MEDIA

Pangnal's media career is where many Maranaw people know him best.

Sultan Atty. Dimapuno Ramos Datu



Full Name	Sultan Atty. Dimapuno Ramos Datu
Nickname	Pangnal ("The Inquirer")
Born	June 12, 1945
Birthplace	Raya, Balindong, Lanao del Sur
Ethnicity	Maranaw (Iranaon)
Royal Title	Sultan of the Royal House of Raya Present
Professions	Lawyer, Educator, Journalist, Public Servant
Alma Mater	University of the East (A.B. Political Science, Cum Laude; LLB, Dalupan Law Scholar); University of the Philippines Diliman (Doctoral Units, Political Science)
Political Office	Vice-Governor, Lanao del Sur
Academic Post	Dean, College of Business Administration, Mindanao

He was the publisher and editor of the *Philippine Crescent*, a local newspaper tabloid that served Lanao del Sur and Marawi City. Through it, he gave the province a local press voice that wasn't afraid to name names or ask hard questions.

He was elected the first President of the Marawi City Press, and also the first President of Radio Ranao Patrol "45," a broadcast media outfit whose identity was built on exactly what the name suggests: fearless, relentless reporting.

His radio commentaries and expose journalism became part of the daily rhythm of life in Marawi City. He tackled the issues of the day with the kind of directness people in the community needed, and that earned him something real: the respect and reverence of the Maranaw community and the common masses.

During the 1996 and 1998 elections, he volunteered as NAMFREL representative and served as ANCHORMAN for the radio program "Knowing the Issues and Candidates," a public service broadcast over DXAD Radio Ranao, the only station covering Marawi City and Lanao del Sur at the time.

That's civic work that doesn't stop when the microphone goes off. It shapes how communities understand their choices, their government, and themselves.

	State University (1980–1985)
Spouse	Bai Hadja Zubaida "Aida" Alonto Tagoranao
Children	11
Grandchildren	21

NOTABILITY

One of the top 50 model Sultans of Iranaon; elected Vice-Governor of Lanao del Sur; pioneer of the Maranaw press and civic broadcast journalism; and founding president of Muslim workers' and professional organizations in Muslim Mindanao.

KNOWN FOR

Fearless radio commentary and expose journalism; championing clean, transparent governance; founding the Marawi City Press and Radio Ranao Patrol "45"; leading MSU's College of Business Administration through a landmark decade; and lifelong service to the Maranaw people across law, education, media, and public life.

PULL QUOTE

"His life is one of continuous involvement and relevance."

LEGAL AND PUBLIC SERVICE CAREER

Pangnal's legal career reflected the same principles that drove his journalism: a commitment to truth, accountability, and the rights of ordinary people.

He served as a human rights FLAG (Free Legal Assistance Group) lawyer for Marawi City and the Lanao del Sur chapter, taking on cases that others might have passed on.

He held the post of Provincial Attorney of Lanao del Sur, serving as the province's chief legal officer.

He also served as Port Collector of Customs at two separate ports: the Port of General Santos City and the Port of Parang, Cotabato City, roles that required both legal precision and an understanding of the country's broader economic systems.

As elected Vice-Governor of Lanao del Sur, he brought all of this experience into the provincial government, consistently pushing for clean, transparent, and responsible governance and maintaining a public media presence that kept officials accountable.

CIVIC INVOLVEMENT

Pangnal's civic contributions went well beyond any single office or institution.

He was the founding president of the Philippine Muslim Workers Association, Inc., the first mass-based organization in the country dedicated to Muslim domestic and overseas Filipino workers.

The association was built to protect the rights of Filipino Muslim workers and to uplift their quality of life, at home and abroad. It was a pioneering effort, and it came from someone who understood that advocacy doesn't wait for the right political moment.

He's also an active member of the Mother of Rotary Club of Cotabato City, a reflection of his consistent pattern of showing up for communities wherever he happened to be stationed.

FAMILY

Pangnal is married to Bai Hadja Zubaida "Aida" Alonto Tagoranao, who comes from the distinguished Alonto-Tagoranao Clan, one of the prominent families in Maranaw society.

Together, they've been blessed with eleven children and twenty-one grandchildren.

It's a family grounded in the same values Pangnal built his public life on: deep roots in the Maranaw community, a sense of responsibility to others, and the understanding that belonging to a family, a people, and a place is never just background; it's the whole point.

RECOGNITION AND AWARDS

During his term as Vice-Governor of Lanao del Sur, Sultan Atty. Dimapuno Ramos Datu received the following national-level recognitions from independent organizations:

- **Golden Service Award** as Most Outstanding Provincial Vice-Governor of the Philippines, conferred by Fil-Asia Research Society, Inc.
- **Golden Leadership-National Award** as Most Outstanding Provincial Vice-Governor, conferred by United Group of Charities and Human Development, Inc.
- **Golden Professional Award / Excellence Award** as Most Outstanding Provincial Vice-Governor, conferred by Exponent of People's Achievers Magazine
- **Humanitarian International Record Excellence Public Service Award** as Most Outstanding Vice-Governor and Exemplary Public Servant, conferred by Humanitarian International Record
- **Most Outstanding Vice-Governor**, conferred by PHILMEDIA and Mindanao Congress

He was also cited as one of the **Top 50 Model Sultans of Iranaon**, an honor that recognizes not just royal standing but lived commitment to the Maranaw people and their heritage.

LEGACY

What makes Pangnal's story stand out isn't any single title or citation. It's the scope.

He was Valedictorian and Cum Laude. Dean and FLAG lawyer. Newspaper editor and radio anchor. Port Collector and Provincial Attorney. Vice-Governor and founding president of organizations that put Muslim workers on the national map.

Through it all, he never drifted far from the core of what genuine public service looks like: showing up, speaking plainly, and staying accountable to the people who need you most.

For the Maranaw people of Lanao del Sur and for the broader Bangsamoro community, his career is a model of what it looks like when someone uses every platform they're given, not for personal gain, but for the community they came from.

His life, as it has been said, is one of continuous involvement and relevance. For Muslim Mindanao, that's not just a description. It's a standard worth keeping.

REFERENCES

[Source profile provided by James (https://www.facebook.com/james.124838)]

EXTERNAL LINKS

- Facebook profile feature on Sultan Atty. Dimapuno Ramos Datu (https://www.facebook.com/MacagaanAbdulmadid/posts/10204341013485113)
- BangsamoroPedia, wiki.maranaw.com (https://wiki.maranaw.com)

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